territories lost after World War I through its participation in war against the Soviet Union. It only changed its position in 1944.

Bulgaria leaned to the Axis powers as well, although it is also known that the Bulgarian Tsar, Boris III, resisted pressure to deport Bulgarian Jews. In Greece, a conservative dictatorship was established in 1936 but, in 1940, the government rejected Mussolini's call for surrender. The country was then attacked and occupied by Germans and Italians.

In summary, in the absence of meaningful security guarantees by France, England or the Soviet Union, Eastern European nations found it impossible to resist German advances. Their fears would soon be justified: Nazi ideology treated Slavs much worse than Western Europeans. For that reason, casualties of war in Eastern Europe (including Greece) during the resulting Nazi occupation were far greater than anywhere else in Europe. (This includes the colossal human sacrifice made by the Russians.) For example, in Slovenia, 5.4% of the population was killed during World War II and in Poland 16%;[65] in Britain that percentage was 0.6%[66] and in France 1.35%.[67]

Europe of the post-war period, and its collective memory and identity, is based on the experience of Nazism, Fascism and the Holocaust. Generations of Europeans (perhaps excluding those in the neutral countries of Ireland, Spain, Portugal, Sweden and Switzerland) have been brought up knowing about the importance of the lessons for the future that their parents and grandparents learned from the experience of Fascism. For all but extreme right-wing groups, this remains unquestioned.

That is not the case with Communism. During the post-war period, left-leaning public opinion in Italy, Germany and (above all) France showed a persistent and sometimes almost religious trust in Communism of the Soviet type. And since Communism could at least be shown to have its origins in benevolent humanist ideas, which Nazism and Fascism could not, obvious parallels between the three ideologies, at least when it comes to the numbers of their victims, have often been rejected. Consequently, attempts to recognise the experience of totalitarian Communism as a part of the shared memory of Europe were not met with the enthusiasm that they deserved,[68] much to the regret of many in Eastern Europe (and to the satisfaction of the post-Communists in the region, which saw this as at least partial absolution of the past Communist regime). Still, in 2009, the